

Chapter 4

Worksheet

Instructions:

Please complete all activities in this worksheet. Write your answers in the spaces provided or on separate sheets if needed.

Career Exploration Worksheet for Chapter 4

Instructions: Answer each section thoughtfully. Use a pen and paper or a digital document to record your responses. Set aside 1-2 hours to complete this worksheet, and refer to Chapter 4 content for guidance if needed. Keep this worksheet as a reference for your ongoing career journey.

Part 1: Self-Assessment – Know Yourself

- **Interests (What do I love doing?)** List 3 activities, hobbies, or topics you're passionate about (e.g., writing, fitness, technology). For each, brainstorm 1 potential career tied to it.

◦ Interest 1: _____ |

Possible Career: _____

◦ Interest 2: _____ |

Possible Career: _____

◦ Interest 3: _____ |

Possible Career: _____

- **Work Values (What matters most to me in a job?)** Rank your top 3 work values (e.g., creativity, stability, high income, helping others, flexibility).

◦ Value 1: _____

◦ Value 2: _____

◦ Value 3: _____

- **Skills Inventory (What am I good at?)** List 3 skills (hard or soft) you've gained from college, jobs, or activities (e.g., public speaking, Excel, teamwork).

◦ Skill 1: _____

◦ Skill 2: _____

◦ Skill 3: _____

Part 2: Research – Explore Career Options

- **Career Ideas Based on Self-Assessment** Based on your answers above, list 2 career ideas or job titles you'd like to explore further. Use tools like MyNextMove.org or O*NET if you need inspiration.

◦ Career Idea 1: _____

◦ Career Idea 2: _____

- **Quick Research on One Career** Pick one career idea from above. Research it briefly using a job board (e.g., Indeed, LinkedIn) or career site. Answer the following:

- Career Title: _____
- Typical Daily Tasks: _____
- Required Skills or Education: _____
- Starting Salary Range (if available): _____
- Does this career interest you? Why or why not? _____

Part 3: Industry Path – Map Your Future

- **Career Path Outline** Choose one industry or field related to your degree or interests (e.g., tech, education, marketing). Outline a basic career path with 3 roles from entry-level to mid-level or senior. (Use LinkedIn or Google for ideas if needed.)

- Industry/Field: _____
- Entry-Level Role: _____ |

Key Requirement: _____

- Mid-Level Role: _____ |

Key Requirement: _____

- Senior Role: _____ |

Key Requirement: _____

Part 4: Networking and Real-World Insights – Take Action

- **Informational Interview Plan** Identify 1 person (e.g., alum, professional, family contact) you could reach out to for an informational interview about a career or industry you're curious about. Write their name and how you'll contact them (e.g., LinkedIn, email).

- Person's Name & Role/Company: _____
- How I'll Contact Them: _____
- One Question I'll Ask: _____

- **Job Shadowing Goal** Name 1 role or company where you'd like to shadow someone to see their workday. Note one step you can take to find this opportunity (e.g., ask a professor, email HR).

- Role/Company to Shadow: _____
- Step to Find Opportunity: _____

Part 5: Action Plan – Next Steps

- **30-Day Commitment** Choose 2 actionable tasks from the chapter's 30-day plan (or inspired by this worksheet) to complete in the next month. Set a deadline for each.

- Task 1: _____ |

Deadline: _____

- Task 2: _____ |

Deadline: _____

- **Reflection** In 2-3 sentences, reflect on what you've learned about yourself or your career interests from completing this worksheet. What excites you most about exploring these paths?
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